

Prayers for our World and the Church

23rd September 2026

Psalms 36:6-7

[6] Your righteousness is like the mountains of God; Your judgments are like a great deep. O Lord, You preserve man and beast.

[7] How precious is Your lovingkindness, O God! And the children of men take refuge in the shadow of Your wings.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that we can come to You at any time, knowing that You hear us when we call out to You. Your righteousness may be like mountains but You are never far from us.

You have called us to be perfect as You are Perfect, yet we know our sin, and the effects of the curse upon this world. We therefore are all the more grateful for Your grace and mercy in sending Jesus, the Only One Who could pay the penalty, to save us.

We thank You that we have been forgiven and can willingly obey Your Word, as we work out our salvation with fear and trembling, as we see You work to redeem us, and to restore the Creation to its proper place, to bring You glory. We thank You that we can take refuge in the shadow of Your wings, and we thank You that Your promise is that we will never be cast out.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We continue to pray for a world out of order, subject to the curse, and we especially pray for those persecuted for their faith in Nigeria, where terrorists have intensified their attacks on churches and particularly the pastors and leaders. We pray for our brothers and sisters in the faith as they face these enemies, that You would strengthen them, encourage them to avoid despair, and to hold their trust in Jesus. We recognise that we are not facing the same terrors but then wonder if our faith would be equal to the same dangers they face.

We pray for Your church, both here and elsewhere, as it faces troubles within, from compromising with the pressures to conform to the ways of this world. We thank You for the preaching and teaching we receive week by week. Help us to apply that teaching to the pressures we face, so that we see this world from the perspective of heaven. Enable us we pray to resist the temptation to just go along with what others say, and instead to stand firmly but with compassion as witnesses to the Cross and the Resurrection of our Living Lord Jesus.

Ashburton

We pray for ourselves here at Ashburton, disappointed as we are that we remain vacant. We pray for Harrison Sawyer and his family as they move to the parish to which he has been appointed, and trust that the work and wisdom of the Exit Students Committee will result in blessings for him and that congregation.

We pray for the Selection Committee which will meet soon, as they seek Your wisdom in the situation we now face, and resume their work of seeking the man You are preparing for the work of the Kingdom here. We pray for ourselves to support them in their work, and to not lose heart as they continue the search.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand. We thank You for John's recovery and pray for continued progress with his present medication. We lift up to You Douglas and Joan Milne, and thank You again for the wisdom and strength of faith which they exhibit, and which is such an encouragement to us all.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Jake Martin as he preaches today. We thank You for his preparation, and for the excellent training he receives at the College. We thank You that we can be participants in the task of preparing him for future ministry, when he completes his studies.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.